

**POLICY ON PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT OF
WOMEN AT WORKPLACE**

FOR ASTONEA LABS LIMITED

CIN:L24304CH2017PLC041482

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POLICY ON PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT OF WOMEN AT WORKPLACE

1. PURPOSE

The purpose of this Policy is to create, maintain, and foster a work environment that is safe, respectful, inclusive, and conducive to the dignity of all employees, irrespective of gender, designation, or employment status. The organization recognizes that sexual harassment, in any form, undermines individual rights, workplace harmony, and organizational integrity, and is therefore strictly prohibited. This Policy is formulated to comply fully with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition & Redressal) Act, 2013, as well as with relevant provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the SEBI Listing Regulations, which mandate that companies establish formal procedures for the prevention, prohibition, and redressal of sexual harassment complaints.

Through this Policy, the Company seeks to establish a comprehensive and structured framework to prevent, address, and resolve any incidents of sexual harassment effectively and promptly. It aims to provide a transparent, impartial, and confidential mechanism for employees to raise concerns, ensuring that every complaint is treated seriously, investigated objectively, and resolved with due process. Beyond compliance, this Policy reflects the organization's commitment to fostering a culture of equality, fairness, and professionalism, where all individuals can work with dignity and confidence, and where respect and ethical conduct form the cornerstone of every workplace interaction.

2. SCOPE

This Policy applies comprehensively to all individuals associated with the Company, regardless of their employment type or location, and encompasses all forms of interaction and engagement in the course of professional duties. Specifically, the Policy covers:

1. All Employees:

This includes permanent, temporary, contractual, probationary, trainee, and intern employees, without distinction of rank, designation, or seniority. Every employee is expected to comply with this Policy and is entitled to a workplace free from sexual harassment.

2. All Workplaces and Locations:

The Policy is applicable to all company premises, including corporate offices, regional offices, branches, and client locations. It also extends to company-sponsored events, off-site meetings, business travel, training programs, conferences, and any virtual or digital platforms utilized for official purposes.

3. All Conduct and Persons Covered:

This Policy applies to any conduct that may constitute sexual harassment, whether direct or indirect, verbal, non-verbal, physical, or digital. It applies to actions by employees, contractors, consultants, vendors, clients, or any third party who interact with the Company in a professional capacity.

The Policy covers incidents that occur during the course of employment or professional engagement, including any situation where an individual represents or is associated with the Company.

By encompassing all employees, locations, and potential sources of harassment, this Policy ensures a uniform, organization-wide standard of conduct, reinforcing the Company's commitment to a safe, respectful, and inclusive workplace for all individuals.

3. DEFINITION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT

For the purposes of this Policy, sexual harassment is defined as any unwelcome, explicit, implicit, or offensive act, conduct, or behavior of a sexual nature that interferes with an individual's work performance, threatens their well-being, or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment. Sexual harassment may occur verbal, physical, visual, or digital form, and may be committed by anyone in the workplace, including employees, contractors, vendors, clients, or third parties.

The following non-exhaustive list illustrates behaviors that constitute sexual harassment:

➤ **Physical Conduct:**

- Any unwelcome physical contact, including touching, patting, pinching, brushing against the body, or inappropriate gestures.
- Physical advances, assault, or coercion of a sexual nature.

➤ **Verbal Conduct:**

- Sexual comments, jokes, or remarks, including teasing, innuendo, or sexual propositions.
- Offensive comments about appearance, clothing, or body parts.
- Suggestive or lewd conversations or messages that create discomfort.

➤ **Non-Verbal or Visual Conduct:**

- Displaying sexually explicit material, posters, images, emails, messages, or social media content that is offensive.
- Obscene gestures, staring, or leering with sexual intent.

➤ **Quid Pro Quo Harassment:**

- Demanding or implying that sexual favors are necessary for career advancement, promotion, employment retention, or other professional benefits.
- Threats, retaliation, or disadvantage imposed on refusal to comply with sexual advances.

➤ **Hostile Work Environment:**

- Creating a work atmosphere that is intimidating, humiliating, offensive, or hostile, even if the conduct is not directed at a specific individual.
- Persistent unwelcome conduct that interferes with work performance or emotional well-being.

This definition is fully aligned with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition & Redressal) Act, 2013, and incorporates relevant interpretations from judicial pronouncements and statutory guidelines to ensure clarity, enforceability, and organizational compliance.

4. INTERNAL COMPLAINTS COMMITTEE (ICC)

In accordance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition & Redressal) Act, 2013, the Company shall constitute an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) to ensure timely, impartial, and confidential resolution of complaints of sexual harassment. The ICC serves as the primary mechanism for implementing this Policy and fostering a safe and respectful workplace.

4.1 Composition

The ICC shall consist of a minimum of four members, ensuring compliance with statutory requirements:

1. **Presiding Officer:** A senior female employee of the Company, appointed as the Presiding Officer to lead the Committee and oversee inquiries.
2. **Employee Representatives:** At least two employees of the Company, preferably familiar with workplace procedures, to represent the employee body and provide a balanced perspective.
3. **External Member:** One member from a non-governmental organization (NGO), legal, or professional background with expertise in women's rights or workplace harassment prevention, ensuring independence and fairness in proceedings.

The tenure, responsibilities, and rotation of the ICC members shall be defined and communicated by the HR Department, ensuring continuity, transparency, and accountability.

4.2 Responsibilities of the ICC

The ICC is entrusted with the following key responsibilities:

1. **Receiving Complaints:** Accept and register all complaints related to sexual harassment, whether written or verbal, ensuring acknowledgment to the complainant.
2. **Inquiry and Investigation:** Conduct a thorough, impartial, and confidential inquiry into each complaint. Provide both the complainant and the respondent a fair opportunity to present evidence and witnesses. Maintain strict confidentiality to protect the dignity and privacy of all parties involved.
3. **Recommendations and Corrective Actions:** Recommend appropriate corrective or disciplinary measures to the management based on inquiry findings. Actions may range from counseling and warning to transfer, suspension, or termination, depending on the severity of the misconduct.
4. **Record-Keeping and Reporting:** Maintain comprehensive records of all complaints, inquiries, and outcomes. Submit annual reports to the Board of Directors and relevant regulatory authorities, summarizing complaints received, actions taken, and recommendations for improving workplace practices.
5. **Awareness and Training:** Support the HR Department in conducting training sessions, awareness programs, and communication campaigns regarding the POSH Policy and complaint procedures.

4.3 Key Principles for ICC Functioning

- **Fairness:** All inquiries shall be unbiased, impartial, and based on facts and evidence.
- **Confidentiality:** Strict confidentiality must be maintained for complainants, respondents, and witnesses.
- **Timeliness:** Complaints shall be addressed promptly and efficiently, adhering to statutory timelines.
- **Non-Retaliation:** The ICC ensures protection against retaliation, victimization, or discrimination for anyone raising a complaint in good faith.

5. COMPLAINT MECHANISM

In compliance with the provisions of the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition & Redressal) Act, 2013, the Company shall establish an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) as the principal body responsible for addressing complaints of sexual harassment.

The ICC is entrusted with the responsibility to ensure that all complaints are handled promptly, impartially, and with the highest degree of confidentiality. Its role encompasses:

- **Receiving and assessing complaints:** The ICC provides a structured and accessible process for employees to report incidents of sexual harassment, ensuring that all complaints are documented and acknowledged in a timely manner.
- **Conducting investigations:** The committee undertakes thorough and unbiased inquiries into reported cases, gathering evidence, interviewing complainants, respondents, and witnesses, and maintaining records in strict confidentiality.
- **Recommending corrective measures:** Based on the findings of the investigation, the ICC suggests appropriate corrective or disciplinary actions in accordance with Company policy and applicable law.
- **Ensuring protection and support:** The ICC safeguards the rights of complainants, witnesses, and respondents, providing protection against retaliation, intimidation, or victimization during and after the inquiry process.
- **Promoting awareness and compliance:** In addition to resolving complaints, the ICC plays a proactive role in promoting a safe and respectful workplace through training, awareness programs, and continuous engagement with employees.

The ICC serves as a critical pillar for upholding workplace dignity, fostering a culture of respect, and maintaining professionalism at all organizational levels. Employees are encouraged to utilize this mechanism without hesitation, confident that their concerns will be addressed fairly, discreetly, and effectively.

6. CONFIDENTIALITY

The Company places the highest priority on maintaining the confidentiality of all matters related to complaints, investigations, and associated proceedings under this Policy.

- All information, documentation, and discussions pertaining to complaints shall be treated as strictly confidential.
- Any unauthorized disclosure of information or breach of confidentiality, including any form of victimization or intimidation of complainants, witnesses, or individuals involved in the inquiry process, shall be regarded as a serious violation of this Policy.

- Such violations may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, in accordance with the Company's disciplinary procedures.

7. PROTECTION AGAINST RETALIATION

The Company is committed to providing a safe and supportive environment and strictly prohibits any form of retaliation or victimization against individuals who, in good faith:

- File a complaint under this Policy,
- Participate in any inquiry or investigation, or
- Report any violation of this Policy.

Retaliation, intimidation, or any adverse action against employees for exercising their rights under this Policy shall be treated as a serious act of misconduct and will attract strict disciplinary measures.

8. AWARENESS AND TRAINING

To foster a respectful and safe workplace, the Company shall conduct regular programs to enhance awareness and understanding of the Policy among employees. These initiatives shall include:

- Structured training sessions, workshops, and awareness campaigns, designed to educate employees about their rights and responsibilities under this Policy and applicable law.
- Guidance on the procedures for reporting complaints and cooperating with inquiries.
- Clear communication of the consequences of sexual harassment and the Company's zero-tolerance approach.

These efforts aim to promote a proactive and informed workforce, equipped to recognize, prevent, and address instances of sexual harassment effectively.

9. REPORTING AND MONITORING

The Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) shall monitor the implementation of this Policy and maintain comprehensive records of complaints and their resolution. In line with this responsibility:

- The ICC shall submit an annual report to the Board, providing a summary that includes:
 - The number of complaints received, resolved, or pending,
 - Corrective and preventive measures undertaken, and
 - Recommendations for strengthening policies or improving the workplace environment.
- The Board shall review the report to ensure compliance with statutory requirements and reinforce organizational commitment to a safe and respectful work environment.

10. POLICY REVIEW

This Policy shall be reviewed at least once every year by the Human Resources Department in consultation with the ICC to ensure:

- Alignment with any amendments or updates to relevant statutory provisions,
- Effectiveness in preventing, addressing, and resolving complaints of sexual harassment, and
- Continuous improvement in promoting a safe, inclusive, and respectful workplace culture.

Revisions, where necessary, shall be communicated to all employees and incorporated into the organizational framework promptly.

11. DISCLAIMER

This Policy is intended to supplement, and not limit, any legal rights available to employees under civil, criminal, or labor laws. Employees retain the right to:

- Approach appropriate statutory authorities, labor departments, or courts for legal remedies,
- File complaints outside the organizational framework, as per applicable law.

The existence of this Policy does not preclude employees from seeking remedies under external legal channels, in addition to pursuing resolution within the Company.

APPROVAL AND ADOPTION

This Policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of the Company and is effective from 06.02.2026. All employees are required to acknowledge and comply with this Policy.
